

How steep? Price climbs 90% faster in bear markets than in bull markets. To check this, I borrowed a radar gun from the police.

How many change trend? This is a measure of how many rounding bottoms see price climb more than 20% after the breakout. I consider values above 50% to be terrific, so I'm happy to report that I'm, well, happy.

[Table 55.3](#) shows failure rates. They start small but quickly climb with the bull market showing slightly better results (fewer failures). That observation is no surprise because upward breakouts in bear markets is a countertrend move, which is like swimming against the current.

Half the patterns in bull markets rise less than 35% (it's closer to 30%). That is a good showing compared to other chart pattern types. For bear markets, half the patterns rise less than 25%.

Notice how the failure rate climbs for small changes in the maximum price rise. For example, in bear markets, the failure rate more than triples to 20% from 6% for moves of 5% to 10%. The 15% maximum price rise is more than five times as high (32%) as the breakeven rate.

Suppose the measure rule predicts price will reach 22 from 20, a rise of 10%. How many rounding bottoms will fail to see more than a 10% rise? Answer: 14% in bull markets and 20% in bear markets.

[Table 55.4](#) shows breakout-related statistics.

Breakout direction. The breakout direction, by definition, is upward. If price closes below the bottom of the pattern before closing above the top of it, then you don't have a valid rounding bottom. Instead, what you have is a mistake.